

Help Decide the Future of Your Cincinnati Contra Dance!

Come to the Meeting April 8 at 6 pm, 3rd Floor of Our Dance Hall

It's time for us to start exploring whether to allow or maybe encourage callers to use gender-free terms like Left & Right, Lead & Follow, or Larks & Ravens when calling at Cincinnati Contra dances ... or whether to keep things as they are. We also need to consider what process to use to decide. We want a collaborative approach to find an outcome that's acceptable to all of us.

April 8 you are invited to speak your mind and listen to everyone else – what people think, and maybe why, and how they propose that we proceed. There'll be a time limit of 1½ minutes for each person, until everyone has had a chance to speak once. The Board strongly recommends that you write out what you want to say, and then read out your comment, to make sure you can finish in time and not forget your Most Important Point. The overriding guideline will be civil, respectful sharing and listening.

In addition to the Secretary taking Notes, we've recruited people to summarize everyone's statements on flipcharts. That way you can see that you were heard correctly.

After Round 1 there should be some time for follow-up comments and questions. If things go well we may be able to agree on some processes that the dancers will use to help reach their eventual decision.

Any Voting Member of the Cincinnati Contra Dancers can attend, speak, and vote in this meeting. If you want to join in the discussion or any decisions, bring your Voting Member status up-to-date. That means you must have paid your \$1 annual membership dues within the last year, and signed the roster of Voting Members. The roster is on stage at each Monday and Saturday Cincinnati Contra Dance.

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Why have this meeting? Contra dancers around the country are exploring whether and how to adjust their practices. Many of them want to continue demonstrating their long-time commitment to welcome as many people and as many types of people as possible. Revising the caller's role terminology may be more welcoming for LGBTQ folks. The change is also appealing to the many dancers nowadays who are reluctant to feel constrained by dances called in terms of "ladies and gents". Many other dancers feel that we're already very welcoming to everyone, that dancers already freely swap roles, that our current terminology works well, and that changing terms will cause troublesome complications.

So, let's figure out what the Cincinnati Contra Dancers want to do around this question. Come to the meeting!